

CAPSTONE PROJECT CHARTER

This is a living document that you will update throughout the 2025–26 academic year.

There are comments in the marginalia and additional slides [in this folder](#). We invite you to add any slides that are helpful to your work and learning.



The star icon  indicates sections that are required for the **Conceptual Project Charter** assignment due on **12/8/24**.

CAPSTONE PROJECT CHARTER



The VGHF Collection Development Policy Project

This project will develop a full collection development policy for The Video Game History Foundation (VGHF). We will be analyzing policies for digital and non-digital collection development to find what fits for the specific needs of the VGHF as it has grown tremendously in recent years.

Solon Scott

CAPSTONE PROJECT CHARTER



Team Information

**Solon Scott**solons@uw.edu

Principal Project Developer

**Lane Koughan**kirogata@uw.edu

Project Liaison / Doctoral Asst

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Sponsor Information

**Phil Salvador**

Library Director
Video Game History Foundation

<http://gamehistory.org>

**Sponsor's Role**

Phil will be guiding the development of policies and making sure the policies are in line with what is best for the VGHF's goals and users.

Time Commitment

Phil has committed to meeting once a month to make sure deliverables are on track and within what is appropriate for the VGHF.

Communication

I will be in communication with the sponsor at our monthly Zoom meetings and by email as needed with updates. These meetings will preferably be held on Wednesday unless otherwise discussed.

Lane Koughan will also attend our initial meeting and serve as a liaison between the iSchool and the VGHF in the unlikely event of communication loss by either party.

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Project Background

The Video Game History Foundation (the VGHF) recently released a massive online archive of digitally scanned materials which has brought on a flood of new users of their libraries and a lot of publicity. Many users are now excited and eager to help the VGHF's mission but are unsure of what types of video game materials the VGHF is capable of working with. They are now in need of a comprehensive collection development policy to guide the direction of these growing digital and physical archives.

Since the VGHF's collection and preservation practices differ from what users expect, we must identify the needs of the current userbase, stakeholders, as well as the policies of similar archives. I also want to identify what opportunities they may want to guide policy to build towards. We will consider policy governance, acquisition formats, metadata standards and scheduling so that this policy can grow along with the organization.

The VGHF also has very limited resources, so policies need to be developed with the idea that they will be managed by two people with very little time to spare. The primary goal of this policy is to use simple language that will guide the average user towards clearly understanding what the VGHF is and is not capable of currently.

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Objectives

By the end of this project, The VGHF will have a collection development policy that can ensure the organization and users of the total capabilities of the VGHF as an organization

- Build a collection development policy for the VGHF with the following qualifications in mind:
- Design policies to align with an online access-first organization
- Identify the unique user bases of the VGHF
- Clearly inform users what types of materials can be added to the collection with consideration to the limited staff bandwidth available.



Key Deliverables

- Research Report on similar Hybrid Physical-Digital Archives such as magazine and newspaper archives, to identify how their policies could apply or not apply to the VGHF
- Research and Data Report on VGHF User Behaviors – especially looking for misconceptions about the VGHF’s abilities as an organization
- Collection Development Policy Statement Document



Please indicate if the sponsor has reviewed project deliverables:

✓ Yes, the sponsor has reviewed and approved the project work plan above.

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Evaluation

As this project has been planned as a solo workflow, Solon is responsible for all communication of the project between all other parties. This makes logistics around planning, management, and execution simple; the project's overall flow will be linear.

Solon and Lane have scheduled monthly meetings with the Phil at the VGHF to evaluate progress on all deliverables as listed in the Initial Work Plan.

Our deliverables are designed to be successive so that analysis results from our archives and user reports will inform the policies designed at the end of the project.

Our current runway for this project allows for room during March, May, and June for if we need to re-evaluate any of our scheduled deliverables.

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Initial Work Plan

The attached Work Plan is linear breakdown of a simple research cycle with specific overlaps early in the project as outreach to various peer networks is expected to take time. Dates in bold at the top are scheduled meeting dates. [The timeline after April is a projected estimate and is not as settled as Jan–Apr]

Task name	Start date	End date	Status	21.01.2026	28.01.2026	04.02.2026	11.02.2026	18.02.2026	25.02.2026	04.03.2026	11.03.2026	18.03.2026	25.03.2026	01.04.2026	08.04.2026	15.04.2026	22.04.2026	29.04.2026	06.05.2026	13.05.2026	20.05.2026	27.05.2026	03.06.2026	10.06.2026
Capstone Project	21.01.2026	10.06.2026	In process ▾																					
Task 1 - Archives Report	21.01.2026	25.03.2026	In process ▾																					
Subtask 1.1 - Research	21.01.2026	04.02.2026	In process ▾																					
Subtask 1.2 - Outline	04.02.2026	18.02.2026	Ready ▾																					
Subtask 1.3 - Rough Draft	18.02.2026	11.03.2026	Ready ▾																					
Subtask 1.4 - Final Draft	18.03.2026	25.03.2026	Ready ▾																					
Task 2 - Users Report	28.01.2026	29.04.2026	Ready ▾																					
Subtask 2.1 - Scouting	28.01.2026	18.02.2026	Ready ▾																					
Subtask 2.2 - Survey Outline	18.02.2026	04.03.2026	Ready ▾																					
Subtask 2.2 - Design Survey	11.03.2026	25.03.2026	Ready ▾																					
Subtask 2.3 - Send Survey	25.03.2026	25.03.2026	Ready ▾																					
Subtask 2.4 - Survey Report	08.04.2026	29.04.2026	Ready ▾																					
Task 3 - Collections Policy	25.03.2026	10.06.2026	Ready ▾																					
Subtask 3.1 - Compile Resear	25.03.2026	01.04.2026	Ready ▾																					
Subtask 3.2 - Outline	08.04.2026	15.04.2026	Ready ▾																					
Subtask 3.3 - Rough Draft	22.04.2026	06.05.2026	Ready ▾																					
Subtask 3.4 - Final Draft	13.05.2026	03.06.2026	Ready ▾																					

Link to document:

https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1JLRGy-k_qQ0yguvQuPcBQK7BfmwdgNf2VssAVkTZEvc/edit?usp=sharing

Please indicate if the sponsor has reviewed the work plan:

✓ Yes, the sponsor has reviewed and approved the project work plan above.

STATUS REPORTS

Paste all [status reports](#)
after this slide.

February Status Report: Update

Summary

I've set up IRB services and Qualtrix for survey production, and I've changed Subtask 1.2 to be about setting up Interviews rather than Outlining. I've put together some survey material out to a general audience from my findings about the VGHF to prepare for March. I've taken an inventory of the organizations recent work that would impact policy from a 2024 Reddit AMA as well as their posts on Bluesky which are driven by projects being ready for public release. I'm trying to understand all of the various kinds of value historians, hobbyist preservationists, indie developers, and corporate games teams can have that will impact VGHF's future project development. I'll be getting in touch with interview subjects very soon to better understand what is most valued by the VGHF's users. I've been given a strong lead on technical writers who might best understand what the VGHF will need in the future.

Key Milestones

Task 1 – Archives Report:

STATUS: **AT RISK**

I need to get in touch with various archive as soon as tomorrow so this doesn't fall behind. I want to be able to build a full report of how Digital/Physical hybrid Archives function by March and I can't do that without taking the step to get in contact with the leads I've developed.

Task 2 – Users Report:

STATUS: **ON TRACK**

I have been so excited to identify users that I've investigated VGHF's recent strategies for developing projects as well as developed full survey materials for independent developers. Next up, I work with Lane to pitch a design direction for Phil by this Wednesday's meeting. There is a slideshow presentation already in the works for this and I'm confident in this month's upcoming meeting! The next steps are to take those meeting notes from Phil and use that direction to start building a rough draft of the survey.

Task 3 – Collections Policy:

STATUS: **ON TRACK**

Coming soon...

Issues and Challenges

This project charter format has been super helpful, but I'm worried my notebook is going to become too big and too distracted by how wide my librarian awe seems to be exploring the space. Since there's very little scholarship or resources on videogame librarianship I am finding I need to contact a lot of individuals like State Archives and City Libraries who obviously have nothing for me, yet I still need to check in with them to make sure there aren't local heritage opportunities for videogames that I'm taking for granted. If local regions could work with videogame developers like they work with other artists, it would be a huge relief for the VGHF who seems to constantly be at their limit.

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VIDEO UPDATE: <https://youtu.be/Pk4aR4XhFo4>

March Status Report: Update

Summary

- Collections Policy draft has begun
- VGHF's Services are mapped out
- Qualtrics survey for user data has begun: first draft will be finished by 03/18
- User data will be ready for collection by April
- Archive interviews have started, but have stalled
- File repository for all documents and data have been set up w/ permissions

Key Milestones

Task 1 – Archives Report:

STATUS:

AT RISK

I've interviewed archivists at the Media History Digital Library and the National Film and Sound Archive of Australia that were substantial for understanding how their policy directions shaped their digital library. Especially, how to make sure those policies are regularly revised in a lightweight way. However, I am behind on setting up next interviews.

Task 2 – Users Report:

STATUS:

ON TRACK

The user reports survey is now in the rough draft stage on Qualtrics. Our current users and services data we're using to build the report was given the green light by Phil. Lane is helping with survey design theory as he's developing other surveys for his PhD work as well. Our upcoming March meeting will be great for looking over the qualtrics design to make sure we're on the right track for assessing the wider videogame preservation community and related stakeholders.

Task 3 – Collections Policy:

STATUS:

ON TRACK

First draft of collections policy has begun to take form, and the top-level skeletal construction will be ready by the time we have started collecting user data from the survey and finished collecting archive data.

Issues and Challenges

Getting contact info from archivists has been challenging as many people's primary professional contacts are in the form of abandoned email addresses, unattended X accounts, or paywalled LinkedIns. It's come down to finding out if they use Instagram/Discord/Bluesky and hoping for the best. Also many contacts have spent the last month prepping for GDC in San Francisco which starts this week. So after this week I will have many more contacts available to interview.

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April Status Report: Update

Summary

- We're waiting for the website to be updated so that we can start surveys
- Until then, I've got another Archive interview I'm preparing
- I'm also building our Services List into a Service Cycle for visualizing
- 'Power User' interviews are coming in now from sources to be analyzed
- Collections Policy is still about to be drafted via Github

Key Milestones

Task 1 - Archives Report:

STATUS:

ON TRACK

With the extra time waiting for user surveys to start, I'm setting up a final interview with EFGAMP: The European Federation of Game Archives Museums and Preservation Projects. This should be the last thing needed to further inform what shape a policy like this should take to be best for games, especially when adapted for the VGHF's non-profit flow. We're also adapting the Services List we finalized last month into a Service Cycle Model so that the VGHF's process is broken down into simple parts. This'll be added to the Policy and Reports.

Task 2 - Users Report:

STATUS:

AT RISK

The user reports survey is in the final draft stage on Qualtrics. It just needs a little beautifying and a final run-through with Lane. Once the survey is out, I'll be able to start collecting data and building the final users report to best understand what ways the VGHF's users understand their mission and goals.

Task 3 - Collections Policy:

STATUS:

ON TRACK

Finalized that the deliverable plan will be executed through Github, so that it can be forked and used by the organization at will. This will be the end container for this project so that it can be used multiple times if needed.

Issues and Challenges

It's been tough this last month juggling all the Spring events and graduation process. It was much harder to get a hold of people and get help with this project this month compared to the previous few months. The project has subtly shifted but because of the schedule's flexibility we should be able to keep everything on track by May.

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May Status Report: Update

Summary

- Services Model drafted
- User/Institution Interviews processed and ready to present
- Two more institutional interviews, and one more [bonus planned](#)
- Survey Launched! [Ends May 20th]
- Capstone Schedule [has been updated](#) and everything is on track!

Key Milestones

Task 1 – Archives Report:

STATUS:

ON TRACK

My final interview with EFGAMP: The European Federation of Game Archives Museums and Preservation Projects was so successful that it led me to another interview with the Swedish publishing company archive Embracer Games Archive which will round out my perspectives on special games archives across NPOs, Government archives, and now Corporate archives. Another 2am interview that I couldn't be more excited for!

Task 2 – Users Report:

STATUS:

ON TRACK

The survey is out and generating responses already! During our meeting next Wednesday I will ask for a post on socials and I believe that will generate more than enough data from users to be useful in many ways for the organization as well as for unifying the goals of games preservation that the VGHF embodies. I've also processed interviews and built a recommendations presentation to present this Wednesday.

Task 3 – Collections Policy:

STATUS:

ON TRACK

Outlined and Designed a collections policy that is wholly modular! The rough draft is prepared, even though some of our data is not collected yet. My next step this week is to summarize this highly granular document into a simpler one page overview of the policy features. The one-pager should not have to change much as it is about overall strategies in alignment with the mission and values of the VGHF, that way the longer technical document will be the only thing that needs an annual review.

Issues and Challenges

Poor Phil has had unfortunate availability problems which led to reduced communication around the survey launch, but now that it's live all my worries are dissipating! Other than that, I'm very proud of how I moved things around with huge thanks to Lane for supporting me in all my times of need. Our weekly meetings have been so necessary for keeping things moving.

FINAL REPORT

Please respond to each section; some sections may be more appropriate to your project so each response may vary in length.

You are encouraged to export these pages as an update for your sponsor as well.

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Final Report: Summary

While developing the project and timeline for a collection development policy, I needed to address the VGHF's users and peer organizations to research and identify what approaches other institutions use to find what would be most appropriate for our institution. So here's the work we did that resulted in data:

Users	Games/Media LAM Institutions
Social Media Inventory (Discord, Bsky, Email)	7 Library Interviews w/ Policy Assessments Video - <i>converted to text and sanitized for IRB</i>
User Survey Design, Admin, & Analysis (140 responses) - <i>Qualtrics</i>	Service Process Diagram - <i>Miro</i>
User Report	Libraries & Policies Report

The results of these six projects led to a presentation on our preliminary data findings which generated feedback from the VGHF that helped construct our final collection policy. I wanted the policy to be simple enough to answer directly to their huge number of public users while also being dynamic enough for a two-person organization to manage it effectively. The reports were bundled into a Github repository as the final deliverable, alongside the finalized policy documents and instructions for use so that any edits made over time can have their history easily reviewable at any time by the VGHF. The final policy also features some recommendations for future projects that could be managed within a Capstone capacity for other students who would be interested in working with the VGHF (*Contact Lane Koughan for more details*).

Final Github Contents:

- Readme Instructions
- Collection Development Policy
- CDP Summary
- User Report
- Libraries & Policies Report
- Survey Questions
- Survey Results (Private)

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Final Report: Recommendations

All policy development will be completed and wrapped up during the month of June 2026 – all deliverables will be compiled into a git repository and passed on with instruction to the VGHF. None of the parts suggested at the beginning of this charter were left out and many new research opportunities were added to the scope of the project. Furthermore, due to my extracurriculars, I have found a bundle of opportunities that I recommend to the VGHF for fun fruitful sidequests.

Recommendations:

Join in with EFGAMP, for trading of expertise in effective international games archivalship

Our survey has opened up some questions that are outside the scope of the VGHF, but further research into them by other organizations could be useful for the VGHF to co-sponsor

Our policy development has identified opportunities for more projects that could be appropriate for similar Capstone-level work in the future if there is a desire to pursue these.

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Final Report: Support

At the end of this project, I will handover all reporting documents and my time with this project and the VGHF will tearfully be over. Lane Koughan will continue to support the VGHF and be able to followup in any necessary ways for support. I will be in-contact and accessible as well but a lot of this final handover is based on how the VGHF accepts the work that was done, adopts any/all/none of the suggested policy documents, and then maintains the documents as their own in the future. The policy has been designed in a way where everything should be provided as-is, with little need for further stewardship beyond annual updating.

We are all free to professionally speak about the work we've done with this project as my work was developed with transparency in mind and contains no trade-secrets or proprietary information. There may be information within our meetings that will stay private to those spaces, but those details are not explicitly relevant to the policies beyond where personal and political relationships guide the professional behaviors of the organization. Similarly, some data generated within the course of this production may not be published or made publicly available as I've been unable to identify an appropriate use-case that doesn't needlessly create possible online vectors for possible bad-faith actors to manipulate. This primarily pertains to interviews with private companies for whom public online information could be preyed upon by online fandoms and taken inappropriately out of context.

It was such an honor to be able to work with the Video Game History Foundation and the iSchool on this Capstone project and it would be an honor to help with further projects if any opportunity comes up!

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Final Report: Handover

After our projects ends, Lane Koughan will continue to assist the VGHF which will help facilitate any continuations to the project such as edits to the policy, reproductions of the survey, and follow up on recommendations and future projects. I've developed this Policy to be as lightweight as possible for the org to edit. The policy document also contains a public enforcement attached that if it isn't updated at least once a year that they could be contacted by their users asking why it hasn't been updated. These kinds of transparencies have been fruitful for how the VGHF operates as a non-profit as their user base has a high technical aptitude. The VGHF will also be able to do what they'd like with our generated reports and recommendations – they've proven very receptive to feedback as I've gotten to see from their recent vertical media-based social posts that are getting great traction.

With this setup, I don't foresee any extra challenges or issues with wrapping up and handing over the finished project to my sponsor.

LMAO Solon, oh you sweet summer child... It's three weeks later and you're still IN HELL muahahahahaaa. Keep polishing, it'll turn into some gold I promise!